Daisyworld

At first, scientists criticized the Gaia hypothesis for its supposed implication that the ecosystems in the biosphere could collectively influence Earth's environment. So to enhance the plausibility of the Gaia theory, in 1983 James Lovelock and fellow British scientist Andrew Watson produced "Daisyworld," a simple explanatory model.

Daisyworld is a barren planet, orbiting a sun. As the intensity of the sun's rays increases, black daisies start to grow. They absorb heat and warm the planet's surface to the point where white daisies can thrive. They, in turn, reflect the sun's energy, so cooling the ground. The two kinds of daisies reach a point of equilibrium, whereby they regulate the temperature of the planet. When the sun's heat increases further, the white daisies, able to reflect the sunlight and stay cool, replace the black daisies. Finally, the sun heats up so much that even the white daisies can no longer survive.

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